

Bazaar

QUICK
INSIGHTS
FROM INDEPTH
TESTS

The Digit Test Centre receives hundreds of products every month. Each of these products is put through a series of tests, and is finally given a verdict. The final score is arrived at after considering a number of factors and evaluating them in terms of features, performance, value for money, build quality, and, in the case of software, even ease of use.

For better understanding of our ratings, here's a quick guide to our overall score

- 1.0 - 3.0 - Extremely poor product. Keep away!
- 3.5 - 5.0 - Strictly OK. Not recommended
- 5.5 - 6.5 - Decent product. Go for it, but there may be better products out there.
- 7.0 - 8.5 - Very good product. Highly recommended.
- 9.0-10.0 - Ground-breaking product. We've never seen anything like it before. A definite must buy!



Google's search results history

A short history of the evolution of search, highlighting some important milestones

<http://bit.ly/tLnjWs>

MOTHERBOARD



MSI 990FXA-GD80

Price: ₹14,500

EXTERNAL HDD



Seagate GoFlex 3 TB

Price: ₹13,000

SPECIFICATIONS

Chipset.....990FX / SB950
PCIe x16 slots.....4
USB ports.....2x USB 3.0, 4x USB 2.0
eSATA ports.....2

Capacity3 TB
Interface.....USB 2.0
Rotational Speed.....7200 RPM
Weight1.08 kg

TEST CENTRE RATINGS (All Scores out of 10)

Features.....7.0

This MSI board supports SLI as well as Crossfire. It has the OC Genie II one touch overclocking utility, USB 3.0 support and six SATA 6 Gbps ports.

Performance.....7.5

PC Mark Vantage Overall: 10685;
Cinebench R11.5 CPU(all cores):
5.96; File Transfer (Sequential /
Assorted in MB/s): 55.58 / 48.05

Build Quality.....8.0

Sturdy heatsinks, military standard components like solid state caps.

Value for Money.....6.0

At ₹14,500 the price of this motherboard is expensive.

Features.....6.0

Allows easy backup of data and encryption with the Seagate Dashboard. It is upgradeable to USB 3.0 and FireWire 800 adapters with compatible cables.

Performance.....6.0

Sequential Read / Write (MB/s):
32.47 / 29.18 MB/s; Assorted Read
/Write (MB/s): 31.35 / 23.04 MB/s

Build Quality.....6.0

Sturdy build. The HDD is not very stable in the vertical position.

Value for Money.....5.0

For ₹13,000 this external hard drive is priced on the higher side.

WE SAY

7.0

MSI 990FXA GD80 is a great board for enthusiasts who want to exploit the latest FX series of processors and who want a multi GPU setup. SLI support is a definite add-on. The UEFI BIOS looks really good and you can also tweak settings from the OS environment. Using the OC Genie II we were able to overclock the processor from 3.6GHz to 4.0 GHz. Presence of the POST code LED is thoughtful. But at Rs. 14,500 we find it hard to recommend the GD80 as ASUS Crosshair V Formula is just a ₹1,000 more and it is much more feature rich than the GD80.

6.0

Seagate GoFlex Desk 3TB offers humongous capacity and its speeds are at par with competing USB 2.0 drives. But HDD pricing has gone up across the market, so this drive which was available at around ₹8,800 till around September has shot up to ₹13,000. With this pricing the least one can expect is a USB 3.0 adapter out of the box. We would advise you to wait till the prices drop and also invest in a USB 3.0 adapter if possible. Another interesting aspect of the adapter is its usability with internal HDDs including laptop HDDs which makes the drives plug and play devices.